

Philipp Hilbert. *Product manager who turns onboarding friction into activation.*

Positioning, ten years of B2B SaaS product ownership, now focused on the self-serve journey where data, experimentation, and customer empathy compound fastest.

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Dear Megan,

Over ten years of B2B SaaS product ownership, the pattern I keep returning to is this: the gap between a customer signing up and a customer succeeding is almost never a feature gap. It is a clarity gap, a moment where the product asks something of the user that the user was not yet ready to answer. Closing that gap is what I find most interesting in product work, and it is the core of what this role asks.

At CLINET Platforms I inherited a three-person team facing a roadmap it could not deliver. Rather than negotiate timelines, I cut the roadmap to the top ten percent of features and put the released energy into watching how hospital staff actually moved through the app. The result was more than a fivefold increase in user acceptance, not because we built more, but because what remained was finally coherent. At Rohde & Schwarz I ran the same discovery instinct in a different register: I pushed my way into customer workshops, instrumented two competing workflows, and found that the polished UI-led path recorded exactly zero clicks. Redirecting the product toward what people actually used was the unglamorous decision, and it was the right one.

At Customer.io the self-serve journey is where that instinct compounds most visibly. The behavioral data is already there; the experimentation infrastructure is already there. What the role requires is someone who can read the signal honestly, frame a testable hypothesis, and work across Marketing, CX, and Engineering without losing the thread. I have done all three, most recently building construct8, a two-sided B2B marketplace, solo, where I had no choice but to hold discovery, prioritisation, and delivery in a single hand and use LLM agents to keep the operational overhead low enough to stay focused on the product.

I am remote and async-first by default, comfortable presenting to senior stakeholders in English, and available on four weeks' notice. I would welcome a conversation about the specific surfaces you are focused on and the experiments already in flight.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
